Prodigy Anesthesia Quick Review

Thymus

What are the two most common indications for thymectomy?	Thymoma and myasthenia gravis *Jaffe RA, Schmiesing CA, Golianu B. Anesthesiologist's Manual of Surgical Procedures. 5th ed. Philadelphia, PA: Wolters Kluwer Health, 2014: 329.*
Where do T lymphocytes mature? Where do B Lymphocytes mature?	In the thymus. B lymphocytes mature in the bone marrow. *Nagelhout JJ, Plaus KL. Nurse Anesthesia. 5th ed. St. Louis, MO: Elsevier Saunders Company; 2014: 1017.*
What type of anesthetic is used for thymectomy?	General anesthesia. An epidural catheter may be used for postoperative pain management if a transsternal approach is used. The surgeon may request one-lung ventilation. *Jaffe RA, Schmiesing CA, Golianu B. Anesthesiologist's Manual of Surgical Procedures. 5th ed. Philadelphia, PA: Wolters Kluwer Health, 2014: 332.*
What type of incision is made for thymectomy?	A thymectomy can be performed via a complete sternotomy, a manubrial split (upper sternotomy), or via a cervical incision. *Jaffe RA, Schmiesing CA, Golianu B. Anesthesiologist's Manual of Surgical Procedures. 5th ed. Philadelphia, PA: Wolters Kluwer Health, 2014: 330.*
Most of the anesthetic concerns for a patient undergoing thymectomy pertain to what underlying disease?	Most of the anesthetic concerns for thymectomy are related to the presence of myasthenia gravis, which is the most common reason for undergoing this procedure. *Jaffe RA, Schmiesing CA, Golianu B. Anesthesiologist's Manual of Surgical Procedures. 5th ed. Philadelphia, PA: Wolters Kluwer Health, 2014: 331.*
If an incidental pneumothorax occurs during a thymectomy, on what side is it most likely to occur?	The right side *Jaffe RA, Schmiesing CA, Golianu B. Anesthesiologist's Manual of Surgical Procedures. 5th ed. Philadelphia, PA: Wolters Kluwer Health, 2014: 332.*
What is the main advantage of a manubrial incision over a complete sternotomy?	Besides being less invasive, a manubrial incision can allow excision of the thymus gland without entering the pleura. *Jaffe RA, Schmiesing CA, Golianu B. Anesthesiologist's Manual of Surgical Procedures. 5th ed. Philadelphia, PA: Wolters Kluwer Health, 2014: 330.*
Into what vein does the thymic vein drain?	It drains into the innominate vein. *Jaffe RA, Schmiesing CA, Golianu B. Anesthesiologist's Manual of Surgical Procedures. 5th ed. Philadelphia, PA: Wolters Kluwer Health, 2014: 330.*

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Thymus

What is the primary advantage of performing a complete sternotomy for thymectomy?

A complete sternotomy allows for complete resection of the thymus which can be difficult via a manubrial or cervical incision.

Jaffe RA, Schmiesing CA, Golianu B. Anesthesiologist's Manual of Surgical Procedures. 5th ed. Philadelphia, PA: Wolters Kluwer Health, 2014: 330.

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